FIT 5122 Professional Practice

Assignment 2 - Group Assignment

Assessment 2: Complex Communication

Summary:

An Applied Session to bring together the concepts discussed during the semester regarding effective communication and communication planning. You will undertake a two hour intensive workshop simulating a critical incident in an organisation and how to plan the communications around this incident.

The FIT5122 teams will report their findings to their manager (the tutor).

The Scenario

- A 2-hour intensive workshop simulating a critical IT incident.
- Participants work in teams of 4-6 people, with each team member must participate and contribute to the work.
- A scenario will be given to you in your applied session.
- Printed templates will be given to you by your tutor.

Objectives:

By the end of this workshop, teams will demonstrate their knowledge of the communications theories (Shannon/Weaver and Laswell models and Schramm's insights) and communication design (Empathy Forecast) and their ability to:

1. Define the issue(s) in the scenario
2. Identity and understand the stakeholders impacted by the issue(s)
    a. Use Empathy Forecasting to understand the issues/concerns of each stakeholder
    b. Identify the questions that will need to be answered by the communication plan for each stakeholder.
3. Create Stakeholder Communication Approach
    a. Create comprehensive stakeholder communications that addresses the concerns of all stakeholders
    b. What "messages" should be communicated, and to which stakeholders
    c. Identify and explain how different channel communication strategies can be used to communicate with each stakeholder
    d. Identify the feedback collection mechanisms
4. Consider Ethical Issues around Communications

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a. Such as transparency vs. security tensions, the need for privacy protection and balancing public interest with organizational needs.

Instructions:

You will develop a comprehensive communication plan for approval from your manager.

Solve communication challenges faced by a specific organization or community based on the given scenario. You will define the stakeholders and use empathy forecasting to understand the questions that have to be answered for each stakeholder.

You will then develop a communication approach to address this challenge, drawing upon communication theories and best practices learned throughout the semester for approval from your manager.

Workshop Flow:

1. Workshop Briefing and Q&A (10 minutes)
2. Review Scenario, identify the stakeholders and their communications requirements (30 mins)
3. Complete the template - Empathy Forecast and Communication plan (40min)
4. At the end, before handing in your work to your tutor scan and submit your documents to Moodle
5. Tutors will collect filled out templates at the end of the applied workshop

Steps:

- Printed template will be handed out to the teams in the tutorial
- Empathy forecast template (one for each stakeholder)

General expectations:

- Team collaboration, every member of the team actively participates
- Well-written with clear handwriting
- Good quality submitted file to Moodle

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- All team members must complete the submission but pressing the submission button once the files is uploaded to Moodle

Extension:

No extension available for this assignment. In case of absences alternative assessment will be arranged.

Communications Plan Template:

Team number: _____

Communications Plan Template

Stakeholder	Description of communication and aims	Feedback/Channel (Media)	Key Message	Frequency	Rational for Channel, Message and Frequency and Ethical Considerations

Comments:

Scenario Details:

Will be available on Moodle on the day of submission (Week 9 Applied Session).

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Rubric:

Criteria	HD (80-100)	D (70-80)	C (60-70)	P (50-60)	N (0-49)
Define the Issue(s) in the Scenario (10%)	Clearly and comprehensively identifies all the core issues present in the scenario, providing insightful analysis of their interconnectedness and underlying causes. Demonstrates a thorough understanding of the complexities of the situation.	Clearly identifies the main issues present in the scenario and provides a good understanding of their basic nature. Some connections between issues may be identified.	Identifies some of the issues present in the scenario, but the definition may be unclear, incomplete, or superficial. Limited understanding of the relationships between issues.	Poor to clearly identify the key issues in the scenario or demonstrates a significant misunderstanding of the situation. Issues are vaguely described or not accurately represented.	Fails to clearly identify the key issues in the scenario or demonstrates a significant misunderstanding of the situation. Issues are vaguely described or not accurately represented.
Identify and Understand Stakeholders (20%)	Accurately and comprehensively identifies all relevant stakeholders impacted by the issue(s), both directly and indirectly. Provides a nuanced understanding of each stakeholder's relationship to the issue and their potential level of influence and interest.	Accurately identifies the primary stakeholders impacted by the issue(s). Demonstrates a good understanding of their basic connection to the issue. May miss some secondary or less obvious stakeholders.	Identifies some of the stakeholders, but the list may be incomplete or include irrelevant parties. Understanding of stakeholder relationships and impact is limited or superficial.	Poor to identify key stakeholders or demonstrates a significant misunderstanding of who is affected by the issue(s). Stakeholder identification is inaccurate or largely absent.	Fails to identify key stakeholders or demonstrates a significant misunderstanding of who is affected by the issue(s). Stakeholder identification is inaccurate or largely absent.

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Use Empathy Forecasting to (50%): - Identify Questions for Communication Plan - Create Stakeholder Communication Approach - Create Comprehensive Communications - Identify Communication Messages - Channel Communication Strategies and/or - Feedback Collection Mechanisms	Demonstrates insightful and thorough empathy forecasting for each key stakeholder, clearly articulating their potential issues, concerns, motivations, and perspectives related to the scenario. Shows a deep understanding of their likely emotional and rational responses.	Demonstrates good empathy forecasting for most key stakeholders, identifying their main issues and concerns. Shows a reasonable understanding of their perspectives, though some nuances may be missed.	Demonstrates some attempt at empathy forecasting, but the understanding of stakeholder issues and concerns is limited or based on assumptions. May lack depth or fail to consider diverse perspectives within stakeholder groups.	Poor to adequately employ empathy forecasting or demonstrates a lack of understanding of stakeholder perspectives and concerns. Analysis is superficial or absent.	Fails to adequately employ empathy forecasting or demonstrates a lack of understanding of stakeholder perspectives and concerns. Analysis is superficial or absent.
Ethical Issues in Communications (20%)	Provides a sophisticated and nuanced discussion of the ethical issues surrounding communication in the scenario, thoroughly exploring the tensions between transparency and security, the need for privacy protection, and the complexities of balancing public interest with organizational needs. Offers thoughtful and ethically sound recommendations.	Identifies and discusses the key ethical issues relevant to communication in the scenario, including transparency, security, and privacy. Demonstrates a good understanding of the basic ethical considerations.	Identifies some ethical issues related to communication, but the discussion may be superficial or lack depth. Connections between different ethical considerations may not be fully explored.	Poor to identify or discuss the ethical issues surrounding communication in the scenario or demonstrates a significant lack of understanding of relevant ethical principles. Ethical considerations are ignored or misrepresented.	Fails to identify or discuss the ethical issues surrounding communication in the scenario or demonstrates a significant lack of understanding of relevant ethical principles. Ethical considerations are ignored or misrepresented.